

1.9.2026

Sweet and Spicy Tofu and Broccolini

high-protein super-firm tofu, broccolini, sweet and spicy sauce,
optional side of steamed rice

Lemon Chicken Thighs and Rice

oregano, smoked paprika, chicken thighs, yellow onion, garlic, jasmine rice,
chicken broth, coconut milk, curly kale, lemon juice, parsley

Tomato-Basil Saucy Butter Bean Skillet

shallot, garlic, nutritional yeast, oregano, crushed tomatoes, butter beans, curly
kale, basil, coconut milk

Baked Black Bean and Poblano Tacos

with Creamy Cilantro Sauce

chili powder, cumin, smoked paprika, garlic, yellow onion, poblano peppers, black
beans, tortillas, cheddar cheese, lime, creamy cilantro sauce

Herby Chickpea and Cauliflower Bowls

with Lemon-Dill Sauce

chickpeas, cauliflower florets, oregano, basil, parsley, jasmine rice,
lemon-dill sauce



BUDGET-FRIENDLY WEEK

While I always try to keep cost in mind when creating meal plans, this week is designed to be particularly budget-friendly. By relying on some pantry favorites like beans, rice, coconut milk, and a variety of spices, each dinner stretches your dollar while maximizing flavor.

DINNERS

- **Sweet and Spicy Tofu and Broccoli** (p. 168)*
- **Lemony Chicken Thighs and Rice** (p. 136)
- **Tomato-Basil Saucy Butter Bean Skillet** (p. 243)
- **Baked Black Bean and Poblano Tacos** (p. 215)
+ **Creamy Cilantro Sauce** (p. 294)
- **Herby Chickpea and Cauliflower Bowls with Lemon-Dill Sauce** (p. 174)

PRODUCE

- 1 garlic bulb ● ● ●
- 1 large yellow onion ● ● ●
- 1 medium shallot ●
- 16 ounces broccoli ●
- 1 medium cauliflower head (or 10-ounce bag of florets) ●
- 10 ounces shredded curly kale ● ● ●
- 2 medium poblano peppers ● ●
- 2 lemons ● ● ●
- 2 limes ● ● ●
- 1 basil bunch ● ● ●
- 1 cilantro bunch ● ● ●
- ½ ounce dill ● ● ●
- 1 parsley bunch ● ● ●

PROTEINS

- 1½ pounds boneless, skinless chicken thighs ● ● ●
- 16-ounce block high-protein super-firm tofu ● ● ●
- Two 15-ounce cans black beans ● ● ●
- Two 15-ounce cans butter beans ● ● ●
- Two 15-ounce cans chickpeas ● ● ●

CANNED/PACKAGED

- 13.5-ounce can full-fat coconut milk ● ● ●
- 28-ounce can crushed tomatoes ● ● ●
- 16-ounce carton low-sodium chicken broth ● ● ●
- Jasmine rice (2 cups needed) ● ● ●
- Twelve 6-inch corn, almond flour, or chickpea flour tortillas ● ● ●
- Nutritional yeast (¼ cup needed) ● ● ●

DAIRY & SUBSTITUTES

- 16 ounces whole-milk or low-fat Greek yogurt or plain dairy-free yogurt ● ● ●
- 6 ounces Cheddar cheese ● ● ●

PANTRY STAPLES

- Olive oil ● ● ● ● ●
- Toasted sesame oil ● ● ●
- Rice vinegar ● ● ●
- Coconut aminos† ● ● ●
- Pure maple syrup ● ● ●
- Sriracha ● ● ●
- Tapioca flour or arrowroot starch‡ ● ● ●

SPICES

- Kosher salt ● ● ● ● ●
- Ground black pepper ● ● ● ● ●
- Dried basil ● ● ● ● ●
- Chili powder ● ● ● ● ●
- Ground cumin ● ● ● ● ●
- Garlic powder ● ● ● ● ●
- Ground ginger ● ● ● ● ●
- Dried oregano ● ● ● ● ●
- Dried parsley ● ● ● ● ●
- Smoked paprika ● ● ● ● ●

* Option to serve with Jenn's Steamed Rice (p. 290)—just add 1 more cup of rice to your grocery list!
† Can substitute reduced-sodium tamari or reduced-sodium soy sauce (soy sauce typically includes gluten).
‡ Can substitute cornstarch.

PREP LIST



KEY

- ¹ = Sweet & Spicy Tofu
- ² = Lemon Chicken Thighs
- ³ = Tomato-Basil Butter Beans
- ⁴ = Black Bean & Poblano Tacos
- ⁵ = Chickpea & Cauliflower Bowls

 = used in "prepped ingredient"

 = estimated time

Green = keep out during prep

□ Prep Produce

- Curly Kale (10 oz; wash & shred - yield 6 cups)²³
- Broccolini (16 oz: ends trimmed & halved if thicker than 1/2 inch)¹
- Cauliflower (1 head; cut into small florets - yield about 4 cups)⁵
- Parsley (1 bunch; finely chopped)²⁵
- Dill (3 oz; finely chopped - yield 3 tbsp, plus more for garnish)⁵
- Basil (1 bunch; chopped - yield 1 heaping packed cup)³
- Cilantro (1 bunch; roughly chopped - yield 1 cup) 
- Lime (1; cut in half) 
- Shallot (1 medium; minced)³
- Yellow Onion (1 large; small dice - yield about 1 1/2 cups)²⁴
- Poblano Peppers (2 medium; seed & small-dice - yield about 2 cups)⁴
- Garlic (8 cloves; peeled)²³ 

□ Prepare Steamed Rice (see PDF Jenn's Steamed Rice)¹⁵

□ Prepare Creamy Cilantro Sauce (see PDF Creamy Cilantro Sauce)⁴

□ Shred Cheddar Cheese - yield 1 1/2 cups⁴

OPTIONAL ADDITIONAL PREP



□ Prepare Lemon-Dill Sauce (see Herby Chickpea & Cauliflower Bowls recipe, step 4)⁵

□ Prepare Baked Black Bean & Poblano Spice Mixture

- see PDF Baked Black Bean & Poblano Tacos, step 2⁴

□ Press Tofu - only if you couldn't find high-protein super-firm tofu¹

- Wrap firm or extra-firm tofu in a clean kitchen towel & placing it on a small sheet pan or in a shallow bowl.
- Top it with a heavy object (like a heavy-bottomed pan) and let it sit until the excess liquid is drained, 15 to 20 minutes.